



Cimply User Guide: Managing Orders

Writing sample — Cimply is a demonstration scheduling product for creative studios, built to showcase documentation skills. Not a live commercial product.

Who This Guide Is For

This guide covers the core Cimply workflow for the three roles on your account:

- Schedulers — creative directors, studio ops leads, or project managers who create and assign orders.
- Designers — the staff or contract creatives who complete assigned work. A Scheduler can also be assigned as the designer on an order — common in small studios where the same person schedules and does design work.
- Admins — Schedulers with an added permission flag for managing who's on the account. See For Admins below.

If you're brand new to Cimply, start with the Quick Start Guide instead. This guide is for day-to-day reference once you're up and running.

Understanding Orders

An order is the basic unit of work in Cimply. Every piece of work — a logo revision, a set of social graphics, a video edit — lives inside an order, along with its instructions, Status, messages, and logged time. Think of an order as the single place its full history lives, replacing the scattered Slack thread and spreadsheet row.

Order Status

Every order moves through a Status lifecycle. Status changes are timestamped and tied to whoever made them, so there's always a clear record of what happened and when.

A few rules to know:

- Complete and Cancelled are terminal — once an order reaches either one, its fields and Status lock. The message thread, though, stays open: both the scheduler and the designer can keep posting to it even after the order is closed.
- An order can't be moved to Complete without a logged time entry from whoever is assigned to it — usually the Designer, but if a Scheduler is the one assigned to the order, the same rule applies to them.
- Orders can only be reassigned to a different Designer while in New or Assigned Status. Once work is In Progress or further along, the scheduler cancels and creates a new order instead of reassigning.
- Any order whose scheduled end has passed and isn't in a terminal Status shows a Past-Due flag automatically — no need to check manually.
- Any order whose scheduled start has passed while it's still New or Assigned shows a separate Late Start flag. It clears the moment work moves to In Progress or the order reaches a terminal Status. If an order is both late to start and past its end date, only the Past-Due flag shows.

For Schedulers

Creating an Order

From your dashboard, select New Order and fill in:

- Title (40 characters or fewer — keep it scannable, save the detail for the description)
- Description — the brief itself: what's needed, references, constraints
- Estimated time
- Scheduled start and end date/time
- Assigned Designer (optional)



Assigning someone is optional at creation. Leave it blank and the order saves in New Status, unassigned, until you assign someone later. Assign a Designer now — or a Scheduler, since a Scheduler can also be the designer on an order — and the order moves straight to Assigned Status. Either way, the first time someone is assigned, they get an email within a few minutes with the order title, scheduled end date/time, and a direct link — no need to follow up separately.

Reassigning an Order

Open the order and select a new Designer from the assignment field. This only works while the order is in New or Assigned Status. If work has already started, cancel the order and create a fresh one for the new Designer — this keeps the original order's history intact rather than overwriting who did what.

Cancelling an Order

Any non-terminal order can be cancelled. Cancelling locks the order's fields and Status immediately; the brief, messages, and history remain visible for reference, and both sides can still post to the message thread afterward — only new edits and Status changes are blocked.

Monitoring Your Dashboard

Your scheduler dashboard shows every order on the account: title, assigned Designer, primary scheduler, Status (with its color), scheduled end date/time, and any Past-Due or Late Start flag. Filter by Designer or Status to check in on a specific person's workload or find everything that's stuck in one place.

For Designers

Finding Your Orders

Your dashboard shows only the orders assigned to you, sorted by scheduled end date/time, with current Status and any Past-Due or Late Start flag visible up front — no digging required.

Updating Status

You can move your own orders through In Progress, On Hold, and Needs Review as work progresses. Use On Hold if you're blocked — waiting on feedback or assets — and Needs Review once you've finished a pass and want scheduler sign-off. Only your scheduler can move an order to Complete or Cancelled.

Messaging

Every order has its own message thread. Use it for questions, clarifications, or Status updates tied to that specific order — anyone looking at it later can see the full conversation instead of hunting through Slack. Messages are timestamped, show who sent them, and can't be edited or deleted once posted. The thread stays open even after an order reaches Complete or Cancelled — only the order's fields and Status lock at that point, so either side can still post a follow-up note.

Logging Time and Completing an Order

Before an order can be marked Complete, the assigned Designer (or Scheduler, if that's who the order is assigned to) logs actual hours. Once time is logged, your scheduler can move the order to Complete — at that point its fields and Status lock, though the time entry and the message thread both remain visible and open for follow-up.

For Admins

Admin isn't a separate dashboard — it's a permission flag layered on the Scheduler role. One or more Schedulers on your account can hold it. Admins handle who's on the account: inviting people, managing their Status, and adjusting roles.



Inviting a User

From the user roster, select Invite and provide a display name, email, and role (Scheduler or Designer). The invited user gets an email with a link to set a password and activate their account. Until they activate, they show as Pending on the roster and can't log in, be assigned work, or receive the Admin flag. You can resend the invite email at any time, or cancel it outright — cancelling a Pending invite deletes it permanently, since no order or message history exists yet for someone who's never logged in.

Managing the User Roster

The roster lists every user on the account with their display name, email, role, Admin flag, and Status (Pending, Active, or Suspended). It's your entry point for every account-management action: invite, resend or cancel an invite, suspend or reactivate, change role, and grant or revoke Admin.

Suspending a User

Suspending an Active user blocks their login — it doesn't touch their history. All their past orders and messages stay intact and correctly attributed. A suspended Designer drops out of the assignment picker for new orders. Any open (non-terminal) orders they're still attached to get flagged so you know to step in. Reassignment unlocks on those orders regardless of Status. Suspending a Scheduler doesn't limit anyone's access (every Scheduler can already act on every order), but orders where the suspended person is listed as primary scheduler get the same flag, as a nudge for another Scheduler to claim ownership. You can't suspend the account's only remaining Admin.

Changing a User's Role

You can move an Active user between Scheduler and Designer. Moving someone from Designer to Scheduler is seamless — their existing assignments stay fully actionable, and they remain eligible to be assigned work going forward. Moving a Scheduler to Designer automatically revokes their Admin flag if they hold one, and is blocked outright if they're the account's only Admin. Orders where that person is listed as primary scheduler get flagged, the same as with suspension, so another Scheduler can pick up ownership.

Granting Admin Privileges

Admin can only be granted to someone who has already logged in as an Active Scheduler, never at invite time. Your account can have more than one Admin, and an Admin can't remove their own flag if they're the account's only one — the same last-admin protection also covers suspension and role changes, covered above.

Notifications

Cimply notifies you in-app (usually within about a minute) when:

- You're assigned a new order
- An order's Status changes
- Someone posts a new message on one of your orders
- (Schedulers only) primary scheduler ownership of an order is reassigned to you

Designers also get an email the first time they're assigned to an order, so nothing gets missed even if you're not logged in.

Troubleshooting

“Why can't I reassign this order?”

Reassignment only works in New or Assigned Status. If the order has moved further along, cancel it and create a new one for the other Designer instead.



“Why won’t this order let me mark it Complete?”

Complete requires a logged time entry first. Have the assigned Designer log their actual hours — logging the time doesn’t move the order along on its own, so your scheduler still needs to go in and change the Status to Complete.

“I cancelled an order by mistake — can I undo it?”

Cancelled is a terminal Status and can’t be reopened in the current version. Create a new order to pick the work back up; the cancelled order’s history stays on record for reference.

“Why is this order flagged even though nothing seems wrong?”

A flag can mean a few different things: Late Start (work hasn’t begun even though the scheduled start has passed), Past-Due (the scheduled end has passed), or an account-related flag (the assigned Designer or primary scheduler has been suspended or changed roles). Open the order to see which one applies — some clear on their own once work starts or Status changes; others need a Scheduler or Admin to step in and reassign.

“Why can’t I make this person an Admin right away?”

The Admin flag can only be granted to someone who has already logged in as an Active Scheduler — it can’t be set at invite time, even if you plan to hand them full account management from day one. Invite them as a Scheduler, wait for them to log in and activate, then grant Admin from the roster.

“Why doesn’t this Designer show up when I try to assign an order?”

Suspended Designers drop out of the assignment picker automatically — it’s not a bug, it’s how Cimply keeps new work from landing on someone who can’t log in to do it. If a Designer you expect to see is missing, check their Status on the user roster; an Admin will need to reactivate them (or you’ll need to pick someone else) before they show up again.